

The executive assistant capability map

The same five-level trust model, mapped to the executive assistant role. Read each row left to right — from routine, reviewed support to acting fully on your behalf. Choose the level to start at, and raise it as confidence builds.

FUNCTION trust grows →	1 Reliable hands Routine support, reviewed	2 Standing access Standing access to your systems	3 Gatekeeper Gatekeeps & represents you	4 Delegated authority Decides within guardrails	5 Full trust Acts on your behalf
Calendar & scheduling Diary & meetings	- Add appointments as you pass them on - Send invitations and chase RSVPs - Set reminders ahead of commitments - Convert times across time zones	- Own the diary and keep it accurate - Schedule routine meetings directly - Protect your focus blocks - Build in travel and prep time	- Act as the point of contact for requests - Triage and decline meetings kindly - Decide what you attend or skip - Brief you on the day ahead	- Run the calendar to agreed principles - Commit your time to your priorities - Handle sensitive scheduling discreetly - Resolve clashes on your behalf	- Own your time as a strategic asset - Commit you without checking first - Design your weekly and annual rhythm - Guard your focus and energy
Inbox & communications Email & correspondence	- Monitor and flag urgent email - Sort and file into folders - Draft simple replies for review - Unsubscribe from clutter	- Manage the inbox to zero daily - Reply to routine queries for you - Draft correspondence in your voice - Summarise overnight mail	- Act as first line for all email - Filter so only what matters reaches you - Chase responses on your behalf - Manage your inbox during travel	- Reply on substantive matters within guardrails - Handle confidential email discreetly - Send correspondence in your name - Manage escalations for you	- Be your trusted voice in writing - Decide what you never need to see - Speak and commit for you - Hold every confidence absolutely
Travel & logistics Trips & itineraries	- Research flight and hotel options - Book travel once approved - Build the itinerary document - Arrange transfers and transport	- Plan complete trips to your preferences - Manage loyalty programs and upgrades - Prepare a single mobile itinerary - Reconcile travel against budget	- Own travel end to end - Rebook instantly when disruption hits - Liaise with airlines and hotels - Brief you on each destination	- Run travel autonomously within budget - Commit to bookings on your behalf - Coordinate sensitive travel discreetly - Resolve crises in transit	- Design how you move through the year - Commit you to any arrangement - Manage private aviation and security - Protect your privacy on every trip
Meetings & follow-ups Agendas & actions	- Prepare and circulate agendas - Take clear minutes - Capture actions, owners and dates - Distribute notes afterwards	- Run the full meeting cycle - Chase action owners to closure - Prepare your briefing pack - Track decisions across meetings	- Own the meeting rhythm - Drive actions to closure for you - Brief you on context and people - Hold others accountable kindly	- Decide what you attend or delegate - Make commitments in meetings for you - Handle sensitive content discreetly - Manage board and investor follow-up	- Be custodian of every commitment - Attend and act for you in your absence - Commit in your name with authority - Hold every confidence from the room
Projects & operations Tasks & coordination	- Maintain your task and to-do lists - Track deadlines and flag due dates - Keep files and folders organised - Format and proofread documents	- Coordinate small projects end to end - Chase contributors for deliverables - Prepare status reports - Run your filing and systems	- Run projects and report by exception - Hold contributors accountable - Pre-empt problems before they reach you - Streamline workflows	- Make operational decisions within guardrails - Negotiate and commit to contracts - Approve spend within limits - Drive initiatives in your name	- Be the operational mind behind you - Make significant decisions for you - Commit the organisation with authority - Run it all without being asked
Personal & lifestyle Life admin	- Book personal appointments - Order gifts, flowers and cards - Arrange deliveries and returns - Manage your personal to-do list	- Manage your personal admin end to end - Coordinate household appointments - Plan personal trips and outings - Anticipate personal needs	- Run your personal life on your behalf - Manage sensitive personal matters - Coordinate your family's logistics - Protect your personal time	- Make personal decisions within guardrails - Handle highly sensitive matters discreetly - Manage personal finances in your name - Coordinate your whole life as one	- Steward your personal life as an equal - Hold your deepest confidences - Make significant personal decisions for you - Free you to live, it's all handled

Start an executive assistant at the level that matches the trust and access you're ready to grant, then climb as the partnership proves itself. Brainbox can place and grow the right EA for you.